

THE GOLDHILL GROUP

Signal Radar

Finds family firms where the founder still runs things and a son or daughter is stepping up beside them. Shows you the company's own words as proof.

Handbook · August 2026

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1. Signing in

GO TO	<code>signal-based.vercel.app</code>
EMAIL	<code>jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com</code>
PASSWORD	<code>Goldhill-Radar-2026</code>

- 1 **Open the address above** in any browser, on a laptop or a phone. There is nothing to install.
- 2 **Type the email and password**, then press **Sign in**.
- 3 **You land on Overview**: your numbers, and anything that finished while you were away.
- 4 **Bookmark it** so you never have to find the address again.

2. The five screens

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR
Overview	Your numbers at a glance, and anything finished while you were away.
Signal Radar	Where you start a new search. This is the main screen.
Enrichment	Finding email addresses for leads you already have.
Lead Lists	Every search you have run, as cards or as a list. Open one to read its leads.
Settings	The vendor keys, and what each service has left.

3. Running a search

Signal Radar → the form already carries sensible defaults, so most of the time you can simply press Search.

- 1 **Mode**. Leave it on Hybrid. That looks for founder-and-successor pairs and keeps every other good family business it passes on the way.
- 2 **Verticals**. Eight are available: landscaping, home building, construction, specialty trades, manufacturing, distribution, property services, professional services. Pick any combination, or none to search all eight.
- 3 **States**. Your twelve are pre-selected: California, Florida, Texas, New York and the Northeast.
- 4 **Revenue band**. Defaults to \$5-15M, the sweet spot. \$5-30M widens it to your full profile.
- 5 **How many to find**. Higher numbers read more companies and take longer. The form tells you how many it will read and roughly what it will cost.
- 6 **Signal focus**. Optional. Tick any of the twelve signals from your profile, or type your own words. This changes what the search looks for.

- 7 Press Search.** It shows exactly what it will read and what it will cost, and waits for you to confirm.

What happens after you press Search

It looks for companies in four different ways at once, then reads what it finds. The four are not equal, and it spends accordingly.

HOW IT LOOKS	WHAT THAT MEANS	HOW WELL IT WORKS
Web search	Searches phrases a family firm uses about itself, like "second generation" or "joined the business", so the results are already the right shape.	Best. About one pair in every 33 companies. Gets twice the budget.
Google Maps	Asks for every landscaper in a town. No succession filter, but it returns the phone number and address with the listing.	Weakest. One pair in 172. Kept small.
Directories	Trade association member lists and similar, read for company names.	No pairs yet. Kept alive on a floor in case that changes.
Licensing boards	State contractor registries, where they publish openly.	Occasional. Depends entirely on the state.

Each company it finds is then read. It opens the About or Team page and decides whether two generations are really named, and really there today. A second pass then tries to prove the first one wrong. What survives both is quoted back to you, with a link.

It also remembers. Every company it has judged is skipped next time. Run the same search twice and it covers new ground instead of paying for the old list again.

A big search runs in several passes.

The server stops any single run after five minutes. Everything found is saved and the next pass starts on its own. You do not have to do anything.

4. Lead Lists

A list is one search and everything it found.

Lead Lists shows them all. Use Cards or List, top right, to switch how they are drawn; List is easier once you have more than a few. Click anywhere on a list to open it. The pencil renames it, the bin deletes it.

Open one to read the leads, check a quote, export them, or look up email addresses. Inside, four tabs.

TAB	WHAT IT MEANS
All leads	Everything the search got you. This is where it opens.
Founder + successor	Both generations named, both running it today. What the product is for, and the rarest: about one company in thirty.
Good fit, no successor named	Right trade, right area, family-run, but the site does not name a successor. There may still be one; worth a call.

TAB	WHAT IT MEANS
Not a fit	Cut, with the reason on the row. Shown so you can disagree with it.

The first three add up to the All leads number. Deleting a list removes it from Recent searches on the Overview too.

Making room

Collapse at the foot of the dark menu narrows it to icons and remembers, so it stays that way until you widen it again. Hover an icon to see its name. On a phone the menu is behind the button at the top left.

When it has the wrong person

Open a lead and press Edit people. You can correct the founder, the next generation, and their titles. This matters more than it looks: Find personal emails buys an address for the next generation when there is one and the founder otherwise, so a wrong name spends money looking up the wrong person.

Use it when the crawler has the generations the wrong way round, or when you found the successor somewhere it could not look, such as LinkedIn. Type the name in and it becomes the person the next lookup targets.

The quote and the source link cannot be edited.

Those are the record of what the page actually said, and the whole point is that you can check them against the live site. Who to call is your judgement; what the page said is a fact.

The quote is the point

Every confirmed pair carries a sentence from the company's own website, with a link to the page it came from. You can check any claim in one click. If a lead has no quote, it has not earned the label, and the system lowers it rather than pretending.

Confidence

LABEL	MEANS
High	Both named with titles, explicit succession language, and two or more supporting signals. Act on it.
Medium	The pair is there, but the handover is implied rather than spelled out.
Verify	Real but thin. Worth a look before you call.

5. Finding a personal email

This step looks for a named person's own address, not another office inbox. Separate from searching, never automatic, and it costs money per address found.

Where a company already prints a general address such as office@ or info@, the list keeps it in the General inbox column. That is the front desk. The Email column is the one that reaches the founder or the son or daughter by name, and it reads Needs enrichment until this step has run, or Not found if it ran and there was nothing to find.

- 1 Press Find personal emails:** on the Overview, inside a list, or on the Enrichment screen. All three do the same thing.
- 2 Tick who you want:** founder + successor, good fits, or cut but arguable. Pairs and fits are ticked for you.
- 3 The button shows** the number of companies and the most it can cost. Press it to start.

You are only charged when an address is actually found.

A miss costs nothing, so the real figure is almost always lower than the estimate. Every address found is then checked to make sure it is deliverable.

It looks for the successor first.

Where a next-generation family member is named, that is who it tries to reach. The founder is the fallback.

6. Getting the list out

- **Download CSV**, opens in Excel or Numbers.
- **Copy for Google Sheets**, copies to your clipboard; paste straight into a sheet.

The file contains exactly what the screen shows.

Companies hidden as a different kind of business entirely, such as funeral homes, newspapers, trade associations, are left out of both.

7. Settings

One thing lives here: the six vendor keys, each with its balance shown live beside it. If a service ever runs out, this is where you paste a new key, and it takes effect immediately, with no developer and no waiting.

Everything about what a search looks for is on the search form itself.

The verticals, the states, the revenue band and the signal focus. There is no second place to set them, so nothing can be quietly steering a search from a screen you have not opened.

8. What it costs

SERVICE	WHAT IT DOES	COST	LEFT TODAY	ACCOUNT
Apify	Finds companies and fetches their pages	\$29 per month	\$9.53 used this month	jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com
OpenRouter	Reads each page and judges it	Pay per use ~45¢ a search	\$49.50 left	jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com
AnymailFinder	Finds an email address	\$29 a month 400 credits	286 credits left	jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com
MillionVerifier	Checks it is deliverable	Pay per use \$0.006 a check	10,408 left plenty	jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com
Firecrawl	Reads pages that need a browser	free	693 pages left	jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com
Tavily	Finds trade directories	free	1,000 a month	jonathan@thegoldhillgroup.com
Supabase	The database and the login	free		thegoldhillgroup@gmail.com
Vercel	Hosts the app	free		thegoldhillgroup@gmail.com
GitHub	Holds the code	free		thegoldhillgroup@gmail.com

\$58 a month is the fixed cost, being Apify at \$29 and AnymailFinder at \$29. Everything else moves only when you press something. OpenRouter is the one that varies: about 45¢ for a typical search, so twenty searches in a month is roughly \$9 on top.

MillionVerifier is pay-per-use at less than a cent a check, and with 10,408 credits sitting there it is unlikely ever to need topping up. Firecrawl and Tavily have not come close to their free allowances.

9. If something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
“Not enough credit”	A vendor needs topping up. Settings shows which one.
“Stopped at the time limit”	Normal. Everything found is saved. Press Search again to carry on.
A search finds very little	Usually that ground is well covered already. Try another state, or widen the verticals.
No founder + successor pairs	Expected on a small search. They occur about once in thirty companies read.

10. Questions you are likely to have

How many leads should I expect?

A search reads twenty to sixty companies and typically keeps five to ten. Of those, a confirmed founder-and-successor pair turns up about once in every thirty companies read. So a single search often finds none, and a few searches find several. The good family-owned companies without a named successor are kept either way, because they are still worth a call.

Why does it reject so many?

Because searching the web for “family landscaping business” also returns funeral homes, trade magazines, associations and software companies. Those are removed silently. What you see under “Not a fit” is only the arguable ones: the right sort of company that failed a test. Those you can disagree with.

Can I trust what it says about a company?

Every confirmed pair carries a sentence from the company’s own website and a link to the page. If the quote does not say what the lead claims, that is a fault worth reporting. Nothing is included on the strength of a shared surname or a guess.

Do I have to run it often?

No, and nothing runs on its own at all. There is no scheduled job and no background activity. Every cost follows a button you pressed. Leave it a month and it costs you the \$29 Apify subscription and nothing else.

What if I search the same thing twice?

It goes further rather than repeating itself. Every company already looked at is remembered and skipped, so a second search of the same trade and state finds new companies. Your existing leads stay exactly where they are.

Can I change what it looks for?

Yes, on the search form. The verticals, states, revenue band and signal focus are all set per search, so you can see what this one will do.

Something is wrong with a lead. What do I do?

Open it, read the quote, and check the source page. If the page supports it and you still disagree, that is a judgement call worth telling Daniel about. The rules that decide a lead were built from your own list of accepted and rejected companies, and they can be adjusted the same way.